

L9 Tracking Learning Progress

Pillar	Learning	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	30-35 minutes setup, then 5 minutes weekly	Group Size	Individual or team
Mode	Solo or team facilitation	Format	Any
Prerequisites	L1 and L6 (to provide goals and accountability structure)	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of feedback on learning progress, no visible outcome from learning, leaders not tracking development

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

The dopamine system responds to progress signals, not just completion. Each visible marker of advancement triggers a small dopamine release that reinforces the learning behaviour. This is why games use progress bars, experience points, and level-ups: they make progress visible to the brain's reward system. Learning without visible progress feels like running on a treadmill. The effort is real but there is no forward motion to reward.

Tracking also activates the brain's metacognitive systems. When people review their own progress, the prefrontal cortex engages in self-regulation: comparing actual against intended, identifying where effort is needed, and adjusting strategy. Without tracking, this self-regulation does not happen and learning drifts.

The Exercise

Phase 1: Progress Dashboard Design (15 minutes)

Each person creates a simple, personal learning dashboard. Format does not matter (notebook, spreadsheet, sticky note on the monitor). Content matters:

Skill (from L1)	Starting Point	Current Level	Target (with date)
<i>[Priority gap]</i>	<i>[Where I was when I started]</i>	<i>[Updated weekly]</i>	<i>[Where I'm aiming by when]</i>

The "Starting Point" is essential. Without a baseline, progress is invisible. "I couldn't build a pivot table in January. I can now build one with filters and calculated fields" is a visible, motivating progression.

Phase 2: Weekly Update Ritual (5 minutes weekly)

Once a week, update the "Current Level" column. Ask: "What can I do now that I couldn't do last week?" If the answer is 'nothing,' either the learning effort is not producing results (adjust the approach) or the progress is happening but is not visible yet (look harder).

Phase 3: Manager Check-In Integration (ongoing)

WHAT TO SAY (IN 1:1s)

"Show me your learning dashboard. Where are you seeing progress? Where are you stuck? What do you need from me?" Three questions. Two minutes. This signals that learning matters enough for the manager to ask about it.

If the manager never asks about learning progress, the team will correctly conclude that learning is a lower priority than task completion. Regular check-ins prevent this.

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
During setup	Dashboards have specific, measurable starting points and targets People can articulate what progress looks like for their priority gap
Within 4-6 weeks	Dashboards are being updated (even if progress is slow) At least one person can point to a visible competence gain The manager regularly asks about learning progress in 1:1s
CLOVER ERA data (4-8 weeks)	Learning scores increase Qualitative data references progress, growth, or development Engagement indicators may also improve (visible development is a retention signal)

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
L1: Skills Diagnostic	L1 provides the skills and starting points. L9 tracks movement from those starting points.	Run L1 before L9
L6: Accountability	L6 provides the check-in structure; L9 provides the data for those check-ins.	Run together
OP1: Ambition Roadmap	Learning progress connects to career progression. L9 data can feed into OP1 career conversations.	Complementary